Alphabet Inc.

GOOGL NASDAQ

Buy	$348.60 ▼ 1.46%	12M Price Target	52-Week Range	Market Cap
		$395.00	$244.15 – $408.61	$4.26T

GOOGL: Antitrust Overhang Easing, AI Monetization Accelerating

WHAT HAPPENED

- Stock pulled back 1.46% to $348.60 on light volume (13.3M vs ~20M average recent days) — this is a drift lower, not a dump. When volume dries up on a down day, it usually means sellers aren't aggressive, just a lack of buyers after a 4-day run from $348 to $354.
- The real tell is options flow: put/call ratio of 0.37 is actually bullish overall (way more call buying than puts), BUT there's unusual put buying at $352.50 and $355 strikes expiring this month — that's someone paying up for short-term downside protection, likely hedging into next week's earnings season, not a directional bearish bet.

WHY IT MATTERS

Here's what I think is really going on: GOOGL has quietly rallied ~43% off its 52-week low and is sitting at 64% of its range — meaning the big antitrust fear discount from 2024-2025 is largely gone. The August 2024 DOJ ruling and the subsequent remedy phase landed softer than bears expected (no forced Chrome divestiture, behavioral remedies only), and the market is slowly re-rating the stock to reflect that. The pullback today is noise — what matters is that institutions own 81% and aren't selling, and insider John Walker's "OTHER" transactions at $339 look like scheduled 10b5-1 activity, not conviction selling. The setup into Q3 earnings (late October) is that expectations are high but Cloud growth and AI monetization through Gemini/AI Overviews are the two levers that could push this through $360.

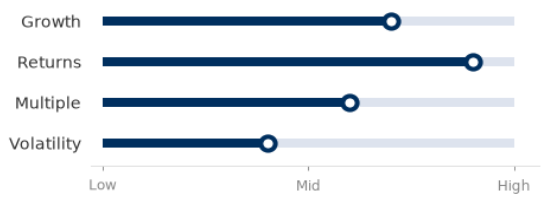
POLICY & POLITICAL WATCH

The big one: the DOJ antitrust remedy phase is still playing out — a federal judge ruled in September 2025 that Google doesn't have to sell Chrome but must share some search data with competitors. That's a HUGE win vs. worst-case scenarios, and any further clarity (expected rulings through late 2026) removes overhang. Also watch the EU Digital Markets Act enforcement — Brussels is pushing new "gatekeeper" rules that could force changes to Search and Android, which is a slow-bleed headwind on European margins. On the tailwind side, the federal government's AI procurement spending (continued under current administration priorities) is flowing to hyperscalers — Google Cloud just needs to keep taking share from AWS and Azure to benefit.

IS IT EXPENSIVE?

Key Data	
Price (USD)	**$348.60**
12M Price Target	**$395.00**
Upside / (Downside)	**+13.3%**
Market Cap	**$4.26T**
FY2026E Revenue	**$415M**
FY2027E Revenue	**$470M**
FY2026E EPS	**$9.85**
FY2027E EPS	**$11.40**
Fwd P/E	**35.4x**

INVESTMENT PROFILE



12-MONTH PRICE PERFORMANCE VS. S&P; 500



This report is prepared by Langston's using SEC EDGAR filings, market data (yfinance), and AI-generated analysis. It does not constitute investment advice. All figures are estimates. Past performance is not indicative of future results. Investors should conduct their own due diligence.

GOOGL — Alphabet Inc. | October 14, 2026

PRICE OUTLOOK — SCENARIO TARGETS BY TIMEFRAME

TIMEFRAME	BULL CASE	BASE CASE	BEAR CASE
1 Month	**$365.00**	$352.00	**$335.00**
6 Months	**$400.00**	$375.00	**$320.00**
1 Year	**$440.00**	$395.00	**$300.00**
2 Years	**$520.00**	$450.00	**$310.00**
5 Years	**$750.00**	$580.00	**$340.00**
10 Years	**$1200.00**	$850.00	**$380.00**

WHAT'S MOVING IN THE SECTOR

HEATING UP: Healthcare (+2.12%) and Consumer Staples (+1.47%) today — classic defensive rotation, which tells me the market is getting a little nervous about mega-cap tech valuations and earnings risk. Energy is also strong on a 5-day basis (+6.63%), suggesting inflation/commodity concerns are creeping back.

COOLING OFF: Real Estate (-0.63%) and Materials (-0.52%) — rates are likely drifting higher, which pressures rate-sensitive sectors and could spill into high-multiple tech if yields keep climbing.

ROTATION WATCH: Money is moving from growth/tech into defensives today — this is why GOOGL is down despite no bad news. Not a trend yet, just a one-day flinch, but worth monitoring if healthcare keeps outperforming.

RELATED PLAY: If you believe the AI cloud buildout thesis, the picks-and-shovels names (NVDA for chips, VRT and ETN for data center power, data center REITs like EQIX) all benefit from the same capex wave Alphabet is riding.

WHO'S WINNING IN THIS SPACE?

- MSFT (Microsoft): Direct Cloud/AI competitor — if MSFT is outperforming GOOGL into earnings, it signals investors prefer the Azure/OpenAI story over Gemini.
- META (Meta Platforms): Ad market read-through — Meta's digital ad strength is a positive leading indicator for Google Search and YouTube ad revenue.

GOOGL CONTEXT: GOOGL has been a middle-of-the-pack mega-cap performer in 2026 — not leading like NVDA or META, but outperforming AAPL. That's actually fine for a stock still shaking off its antitrust discount; the re-rating happens gradually, not in one spike.

WHAT I'D DO WITH THIS STOCK

8/10 Conviction Score

Position Size: 4-6% of portfolio

Entry Points: $338-345 on pullbacks

Time Horizon: 12-24 months

Thesis Invalidation: Search revenue declines YoY or forced Chrome/Android divestiture ordered

Hedging: Buy Jan put spreads or pair with short MSFT to isolate AI exposure

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